

Homework 4, Week 5

Activity 9

ACTIVITY 9

Underline the topic sentence in each of the following paragraphs.

1. Using art as a form of therapy requires a level of concentration that allows a person to relieve the pain of mental or emotional stress. Art therapy is not limited to painting or drawing but can include dance, photography, music, writing, or any other art form. The main goal of art therapy is healing through self-expression. It allows a person to use visual means to explore feelings and emotions, to make the unseen seen, and to discover how the mind works. Art therapy does not require artistic ability, nor does it demand high artistic products. Indeed, art therapy focuses on the process, not the product. Art is therapy; art heals.

2. At some time or another, many close relationships go through a conflict phase. "We're always fighting," complains a newlywed. But if she were to analyze these fights, she would discover important differences among them. According to communication researchers Miller and Steinberg, most conflicts fit into three different categories. There is pseudo conflict—triggered by a lack of understanding. There is simple conflict—stemming from different ideas, definitions, perceptions, or goals. Finally there is ego conflict—which occurs when conflict gets personal.

3. One of the strongest arguments in favor of a relaxed approach to immigration is that the United Kingdom benefits economically from immigrant labor. Research shows that countries with high levels of immigration are economically successful and that there is a correlation between a mobile labor force and economic prosperity. Immigration serves as an important source of both skilled and unskilled labor in the UK which has come to depend on migrants to plug gaps in its skilled professions and to do jobs that the local population are unwilling to do.

4. Though the United States has spent billions of dollars on foreign aid programs, it has captured neither the affection nor esteem of the rest of the world. In many countries today Americans are cordially disliked; in others merely tolerated. The reasons for this sad state of affairs are many and varied, and some of them are beyond the control of anything this country might do to try to correct them. But harsh as it may seem to the ordinary citizen, filled as he is with good intentions and natural generosity, much of the foreigners' animosity has been generated by the way Americans behave.

5. Journal writing is often a very personal and private activity. Some people who write journals never share a single word of their writing. Note taking for a college course is also an act that writers usually undertake individually. At other times, however, writing is explicitly collaborative, such as when scientists co-author publications or when more than one person writes a novel. But even individually-authored pieces of writing are often the result of many people working together. For instance, published writing—from newspaper articles to scholarly texts and to movie reviews—undergoes editing and revision. Receiving external feedback on a piece of writing is a common and crucial element of turning a good draft into something publishable. Given these varied situations, writing can be both a solitary and collaborative endeavor.

Activity 12

ACTIVITY 12

Evaluate each of the following topic sentences and mark them as follows.

E = effective

G = too general

A = announcement

N = not complete thought

S = too narrowed

1. This paper will discuss the life and politics of Simón Bolívar. ()
2. Japanese culture is fascinating to study because its family traditions are so different from American traditions. ()
3. The admission test for the police academy includes vocabulary questions. ()
4. The discovery of penicillin was a great step in the advancement of modern medicine. ()
5. I will talk about the reasons for the popularity of reality television shows. ()
6. A habit leading to weight gain. ()
7. Each year Americans are the victims of more than one million auto thefts. ()

1. A
2. E
3. S
4. G
5. A
6. N
7. E

Text B

Source Text and Paragraph Analysis

Wisdom and Creativity in Old Age

1. Published in 1953, Harvey Lehman's *Age and Achievement* remains the most ambitious empirical study of the relationship between age and creativity ever undertaken by a psychologist. Based on his analysis of the life spans of important **practitioners** of scores of different activities, Lehman summarized his results by observing that "it remains clear that the genius does not function equally well throughout the years of adulthood. Superior

creativity rises relatively rapidly to a maximum which occurs usually in the thirties and then falls off slowly.” Old age does have some positive attributes: **“The old usually possess greater wisdom and erudition.** These are invaluable assets.” **Yet these invaluable assets do not lead to creativity:** “But when a situation requires a new way of looking at things, the acquisition of new techniques or even new vocabularies, the old seem **stereotyped** and rigid. To learn the new they often have to unlearn the old and that is twice as hard as learning without unlearning.” Following Lehman, today psychologists continue to believe that practitioners of most intellectual activities reach their creative peaks relatively early in their adult lives. Wisdom and creativity are concepts that psychologists do not generally consider to be closely associated. Robert Sternberg, for example, recently explained that “the kinds of thinking required to be creative and wise are different.” For Sternberg, innovators are **impetuous** rather than deliberate: “Creative thinking is often **brash** whereas wise thinking is balanced.” *(Introduce the topic of wisdom and creativity for elders and show the opinions from the professors that elders have great wisdom but little creativity)*

2. **These psychologists have failed to recognize the variety of creativity.** It is true that bold and brash leaps into the unknown are an important source of innovations. **But there is also another, very different form of creativity, in which important new discoveries are the cumulative product of gradual and incremental experimentation.** Ignoring this latter type of creativity has caused a misunderstanding of the diversity of creative life cycles, for whereas the first type of innovation is usually made early in an innovator’s career, the second type is generally made by older individuals. **It is within this second type of innovation that we must look for the link between wisdom and creativity.** *(Point out the misunderstanding of the professors to the creativity and show the second type of creativity that is gradual and incremental and is tightly related to the wisdom)*
3. **Recent studies of individual innovators in the arts have revealed numerous instances in which great artists have made their most important contributions late in their lives.** A striking example appears in a study of the greatest women artists of the twentieth century, in the career of the **sculptor** Louise Bourgeois. The period from which Bourgeois’ work is most likely to be illustrated in textbooks of art history is the first half of her 80s. In view of the fact that art historians judge that the most important work of her career was made in her ninth decade, it is perhaps not surprising that Bourgeois believes that artists improve with age. In 1995, when she was 84, Bourgeois told an interviewer that she could not have made one of her recent important works earlier in her career, because “I was not sophisticated enough then. You know, artists improve. I mean, we are supposed to be better today than we were twenty years ago. Otherwise, what’s the use of working?” When the interviewer inquired about the source of the improvement, Bourgeois explained that “you become better in every way, morally, intellectually, physically—no, not physically. You become better, which is really the true philosophy—the wisdom of the elders.” *(Take the example of Bourgeois to illustrate that many creativity are from old individual innovators)*

4. **Earlier studies have shown that artists who make important contributions late in their lives are almost invariably experimental innovators, whose uncertainty about their goals causes them to proceed more gradually and cautiously than their conceptual counterparts.** Bourgeois is an **archetypal** example of an experimental artist. She does not plan her forms in advance, but finds them in the course of working: "The finished work is often a stranger to, and sometimes very much at odds with what the artist felt or wished to express when he began." She is never satisfied that a work or a problem has been fully resolved: "That's why I keep going. The resolution never appears; it's like a **mirage**." Making art is a struggle: "I have no fun at all—in fact everything I do is a battlefield, a fight to the finish." Progress comes from adversity: "My style, the way I work comes from all the failures, all the **temptations** I have resisted, all the fun I didn't have, all the regrets." **(State the significance of keep proceeding and uncertain goals for the creativity and take the words of Bourgeois's as an example)**
5. **Yet although Bourgeois' attitudes are typical of the class of experimental innovators, her life cycle is not.** While it is now clear that experimental innovators tend to make their greatest contributions later in their lives than their conceptual counterparts, most **nonetheless** make their most important contributions considerably earlier than Bourgeois. It is consequently of interest to ask what causes this variation: why do some experimental innovators continue to develop their art much longer than others? **(From the difference between Bourgeois and others to introduce the question that why experimental innovators develop their art longer than others)**
6. **A complete answer to this question is not possible**, for it would require complete knowledge of the circumstances and motivations of all the relevant individuals. **Yet it is possible** that careful comparative studies of small numbers of important innovators can begin to give us some clues as to why some creative individuals persevere, and succeed, for longer periods than others. **(State that the question is impossible to complete answer but the author also show the prospect and method for comparative studies in small numbers of important innovators)**
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Significant Words and Phrases

- practitioner **#CET6**
someone who practice in a learned professors
- erudition
profound knowledge
- stereotype **#CET6**
a conventional image to something

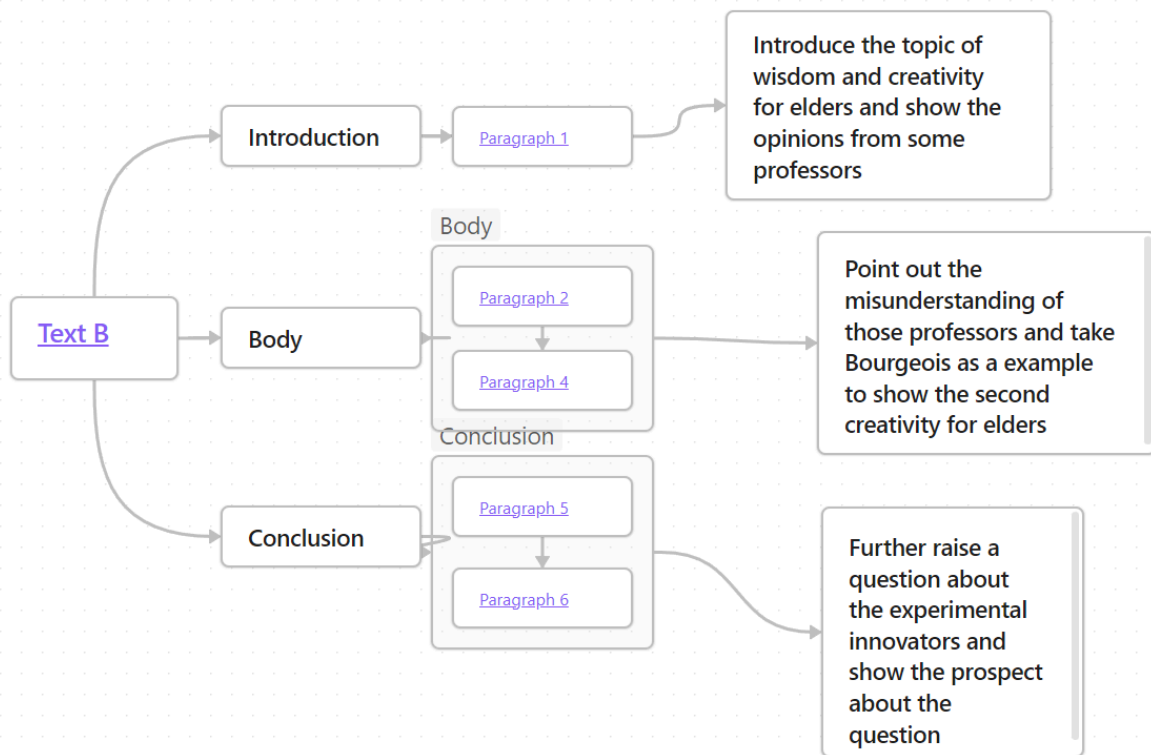
- impetuous
impulsive
 - deliberate #CET4 #CET6
cautious; by purpose
 - brash
impulsive
 - cumulative #CET6
gradual
 - sculptor
a artist to create the sculpture
 - archetypal
original type; characteristic type
 - mirage
fantasy, something illusory
 - temptation #CET6
something appealing
 - nonetheless #CET6
nevertheless
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Topic Idea

This article introduces the wisdom and creativity for elders, corrects the misunderstanding of professors that the elders are lack of creativity and further raise a question about that.

Structure

Structure of Text B



Activity 4

Task I

ACTIVITY 4

Task 1 Think critically about the writing techniques used in Text B and discuss the following questions in groups.

1. How does Galenson establish a close link between wisdom and creativity? Do you find his approach effective? Why or why not?
2. What are the direct quotations in this essay chosen for? Explain.
3. In both Paragraphs 3 and 4, Louise Bourgeois is used as an example to illustrate Galenson's point. Does this extended example really make a case? Why or why not?
4. Comment on the length of the introduction. Is it appropriate? Why or why not?

1. It establish the link by disproving the opinions of other professors that they are not have link and taking a particular example of Bourgeois. It is effective since the disproving compares two different opinion to highlight the correct of his own opinion and the example make his opinion more supportive and concrete and make it easier understand for readers.
2. This essay directly quotes the words of other professors to introduce the latter opinion disproving them and quotes the words of Bourgeois to make his example more convincing and further prove its opinion.
3. It really make a case. In Paragraph 3, it tightly show that individual innovators in the arts have made their most important contribution late in their lives by her own experience and make it more objective. In Paragraph 4, it quotes the words of her to support the significance of keep proceeding and make it more convincing.
4. It is appropriate because the introduction not only greatly grab the readers into the essay, provide the basic information about the topic but also make the latter opinion of the author's more nature and reasonable. If it is too short it won't contain the necessary content.

Task II

The Energy of Eighty

(adapted version)

Christina Michaud

The topic
sentence

- 1 I had the opportunity to interview an octogenarian couple, Mr and Mrs Fillos, who were guests of a college writing class I was working with that was studying the topics of aging and wisdom. After just a few words with Anthe Fillos, it became clear that she was a highly energetic woman. "Do you feel that you're old?" a student asked Mrs Fillos immediately after her introduction. Impeccably dressed and groomed, Mrs Fillos was nonplussed. "No, I don't feel that I'm old," she answered firmly. "Well, when I turned eighty I did feel that this was it—that I might not have all that much time left—but I don't feel old." Throughout the interview, Mrs Fillos stressed the importance of being around young people in order to continue feeling

- What is the topic sentence of this paragraph?
- What supporting details are provided?

The attitude of Fillos towards her life, the quotation of her words and the observation of the author

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young. "You can't just sit around all day, either," she explained, in response to a student who asked how she spent her time. "You've got to keep busy. Every day I try to have a project of some sort." Not only does Mrs Fillos spend time with her children and grandchildren, but her daily projects also include everything from doing the laundry and cleaning the house to teaching Sunday school and participating in church activities.

- 2 By nature a quieter person than his wife, and because of a World War II injury, somewhat hard of hearing for many years, Mr Fillos at first appeared to lack his wife's characteristic energy and intensity during our interview with him. "John, tell them what you did just last week," Mrs Fillos said. Obediently, Mr Fillos told the students how he had dug up some bushes that had been in front of their house since he planted them himself, years ago. "I planted them, and now I wanted to take them out," he said. "The neighbor removed his, and it looked good, so I wanted to do it too." He became more energetic as he told about the hard work of digging up the bushes, about the physical aches and pains he felt the day after his yard work, and about the near-physical sense of satisfaction at having done something difficult—almost too difficult ("To tell you the truth, I probably wouldn't do it again," he admitted)—that he had very much wanted to accomplish. It was clear that for him the process of uprooting the bushes on his own was a significant one, and that it was the source of his enthusiasm for life. But I don't think it was precisely the physical aspects of these encounters that gave Mr Fillos his optimism and energy; rather, his optimism seemed to have come from the emotionally fulfilling aspects of these incidents—to feel useful, valuable, and active. The topic sentence
- 3 For him as for Mrs Fillos, this classroom visit was another one of his daily projects, another of those moments of interaction with youth. The day of this interview was one more day the couple found something to do, one more way of keeping busy, and of maintaining their positive outlook on life.

- What is the topic sentence of this paragraph?
- How many examples are provided? What are they?

One detailed example is provided. It shows the process of Mr Fillos to dig up the bushes to express the optimism and energy of him

Summarize the upper two paragraph that the couple are energetic and optimistic for their daily life including my interview and introduce the latter content

- What is the function of this paragraph?

- 4 In his 1978 essay, "The View from 80," the American poet and literary critic Malcolm Cowley writes that "simply giving up is the greatest temptation of age... The givers-up see no reason for working...but the men and women I envy are those who accept old age as a series of challenges." Mr and Mrs Fillos

have certainly adopted Cowley's view of old age. Although Mr Fillos and his wife may not do any more strenuous yardwork, what sets them apart from Cowley's "givers-up" is an energy and enthusiasm that is embodied far more in their mental attitudes toward life than in any of their physical limitations or accomplishments.

► Which sentence serves as the thesis of this essay?